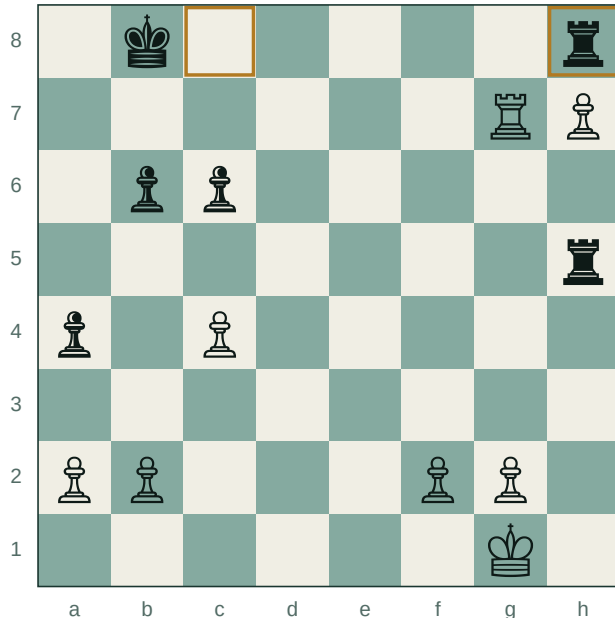


Rook-ending tactics: White, move 46

Rook-ending tactics

White to move



Previous move: 45...Rh8. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

46. Rg8+ Kc7 47. Rxh8

46.Rg8+ Check restricts Black to 4 legal replies here. From g8 it attacks king on b8 and rook on h8. Recorded reply: **46...Kc7**.

47.Rxh8 The rook captures the rook on h8.

At the end, nominal material is White 11 / Black 8 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +5. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +5: the balance goes from -2 to +3. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A routine rook placement can miss a skewer or promotion with check. Let concrete tactics override a guideline when they conflict.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Rook endings combine pawn races with checks, cutoffs, and promotion tactics. Activity is vital, but the exact move order often decides whether a pawn can advance safely.

HOW TO LOOK

Check the kings' exposure, the rooks' checking distance, and the passed pawns. Calculate forcing checks before applying a general rook-ending rule.

The defending king is on b8. Geometrically undefended: rook on h8 and rook on h5. Check for tactical protection.